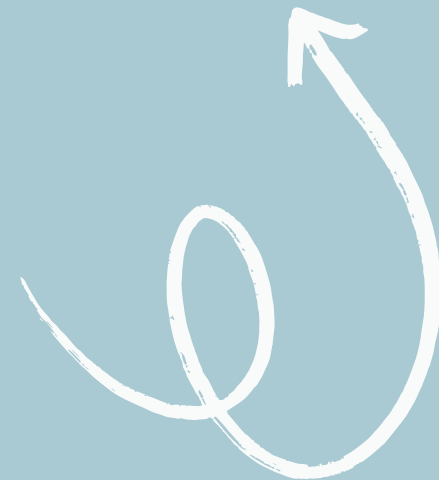


From Idea to Prototype #1

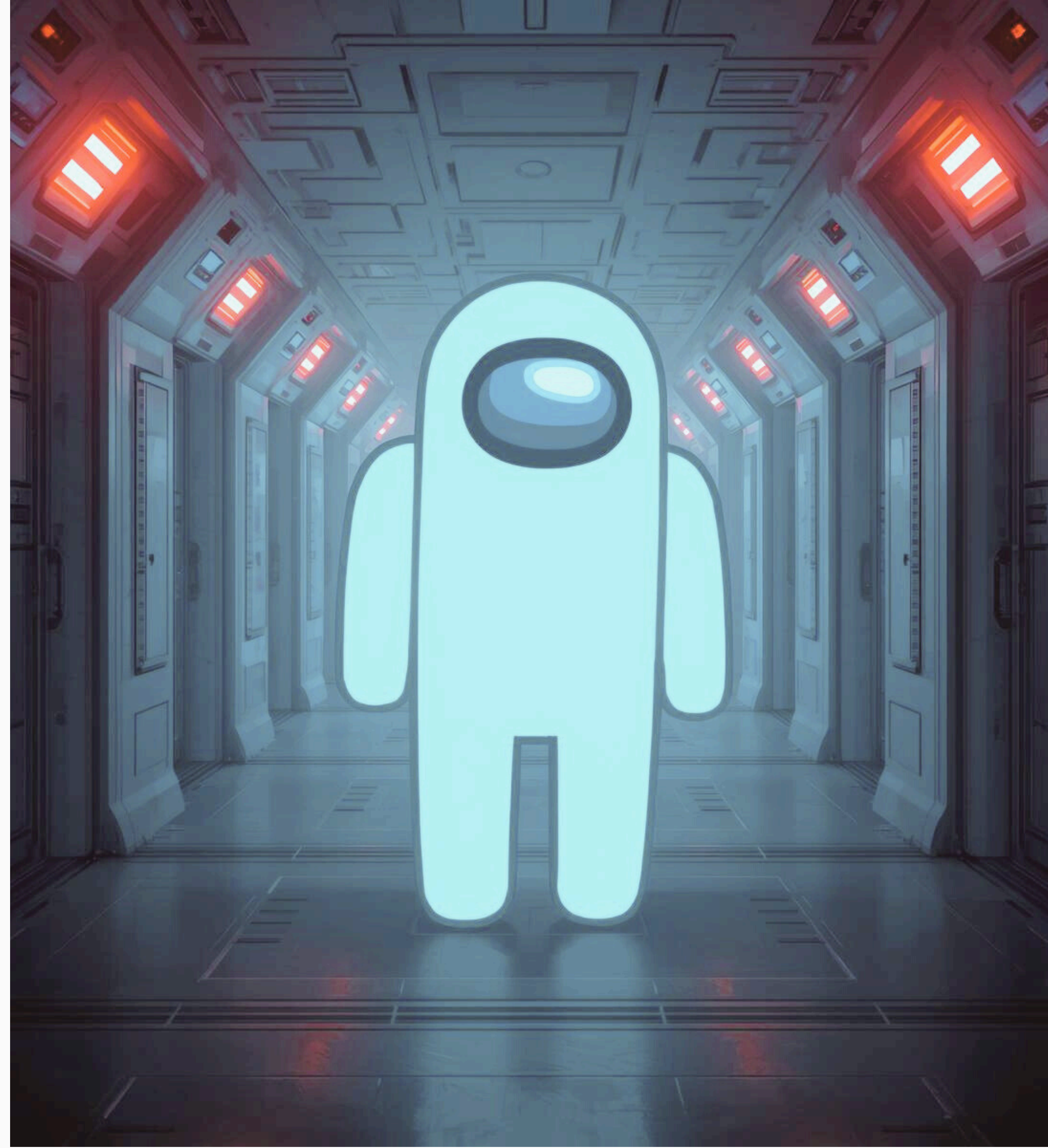
ProjectHack: Learn by building



Overcoming Impostor Syndrome

For a long time, I hesitated to share my project ideas. Not because they lacked value, but because I was over-optimizing for scale, polish, and “readiness.”

I spent too much time refining ideas in my head instead of testing them in the real world. In hindsight, that slowed learning more than it helped.

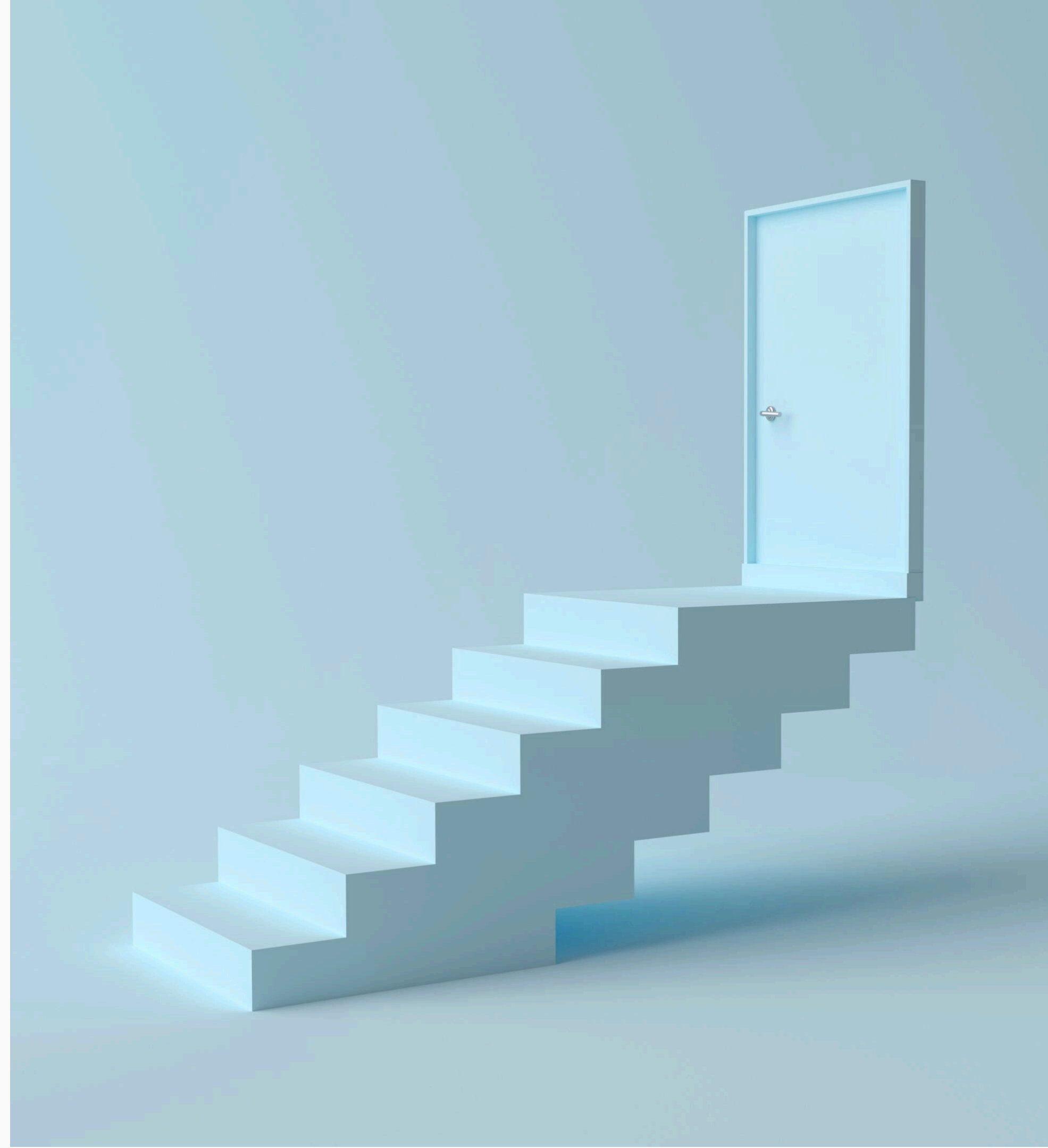


Changing the Default

This year, I'm changing the rule.
Instead of asking whether an idea is "big enough,"
I focus on whether it:

- solves a **real** problem
- **teaches** something concrete
- can be **built, tested, and shared**

My new default: **build, test, share** fast.



Introducing a new series: From Problem to Prototype

Execution over perfection.

What

In this series, I take a real problem, design **the smallest useful solution**, and ship it. Fast, intentionally scoped, and shared early. Using my technical skills and knowledge combined with AI tools.

Why

Because I genuinely enjoy bringing ideas to life. I learn the most when I build, and I believe good ideas become better once they exist in the real world, even the prototypes.

How

By starting simple and being intentional:

- one clear problem
- a realistic scope
- rapid execution (max 12h of work)
- early sharing and iteration

ProjectHack

Over the years, I noticed a recurring pattern among students and early-career developers:

They complete courses, but still struggle to explain what they've built, reason about trade-offs, or present a project end-to-end.

Often, the issue isn't effort, but lack of ownership over the problem itself.

So I challenged myself to start building a product that helps beginners:

- work on a **real-world** project ideas
- practice **end-to-end thinking**
- finish with something concrete, **CV-ready, and easy to share**



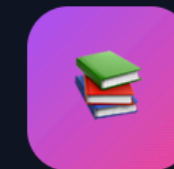
Start Your Solo Hackathon

Choose a project, set your timeframe, and build something real for your CV. **Get step-by-step guidance** and learn technologies that matter.



Time-Bound

Choose 6, 12, 24, or 48 hours. Learn time management while building real projects.



Step-by-Step

Get guided through each step with technologies and learning outcomes clearly explained.



CV-Ready

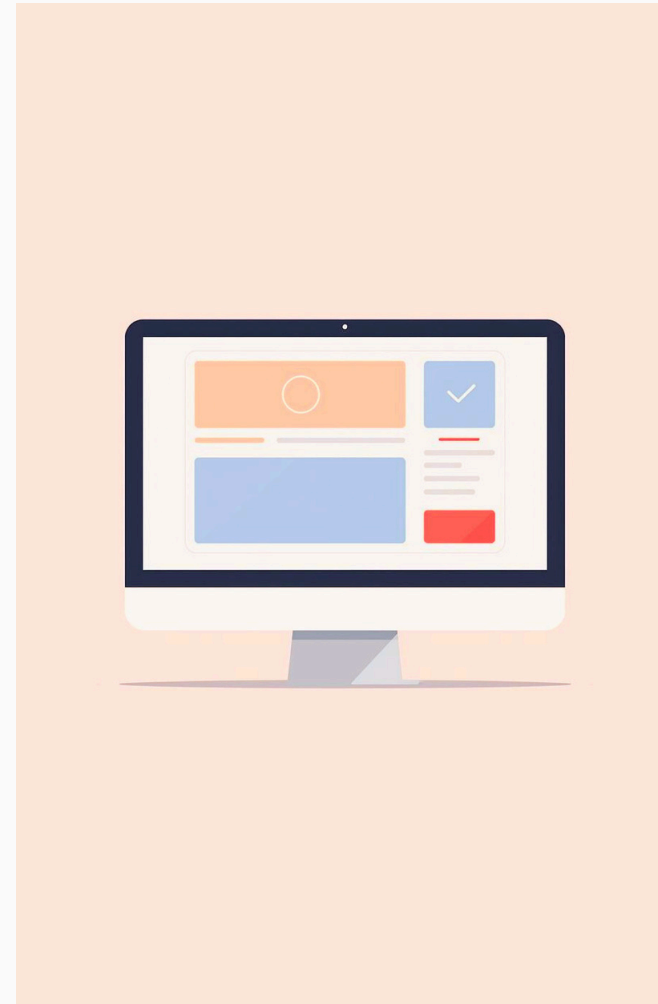
Get a summary of skills learned, perfect for your CV and LinkedIn profile.

ProjectHack Tech Stack Overview



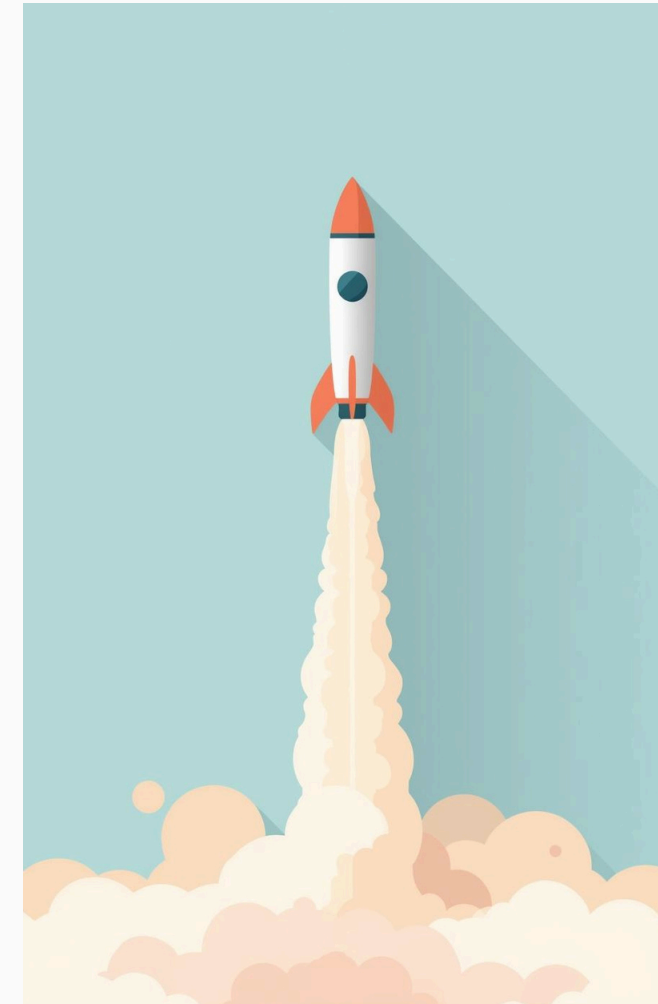
Backend

- Django 4.2.7
- Python 3.8+
- SQLite
- Gunicorn
- WhiteNoise



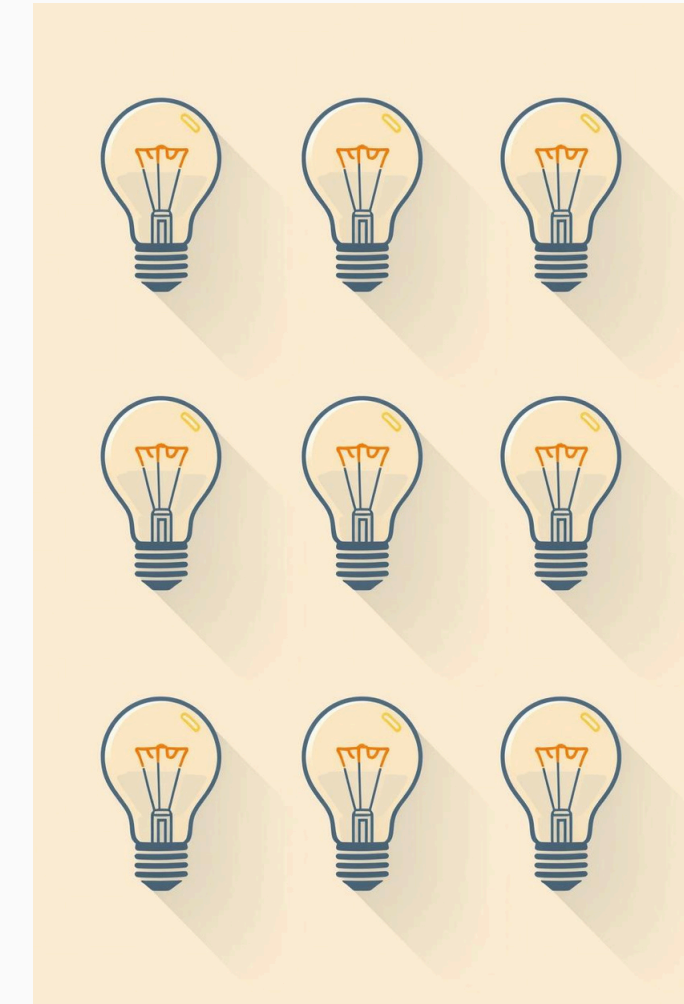
Frontend

- Tailwind CSS
- HTML5
- JavaScript



Deployment

- Render.com
- Github



Features

- Responsive Design
- Modern design patterns
- Session Management

Step 1

Choose your **experience level** and **preferred technologies**. Select the development track, difficulty and your interests.

Step 2

Get a **real-world project** idea tailored to your choices. Choose a time you want to spend on a project to adapt number of steps. For now those are mocked, but the idea stays.

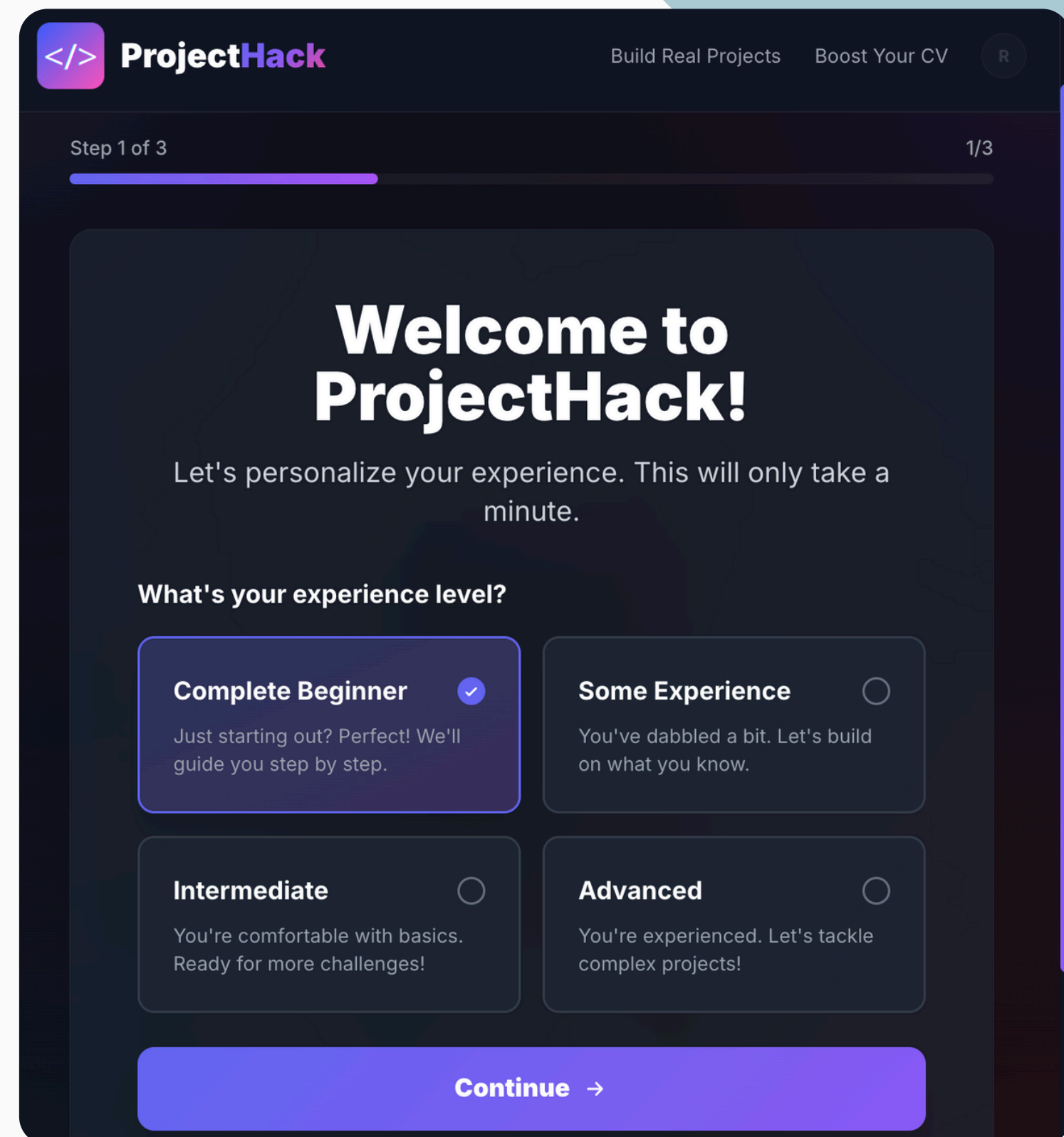
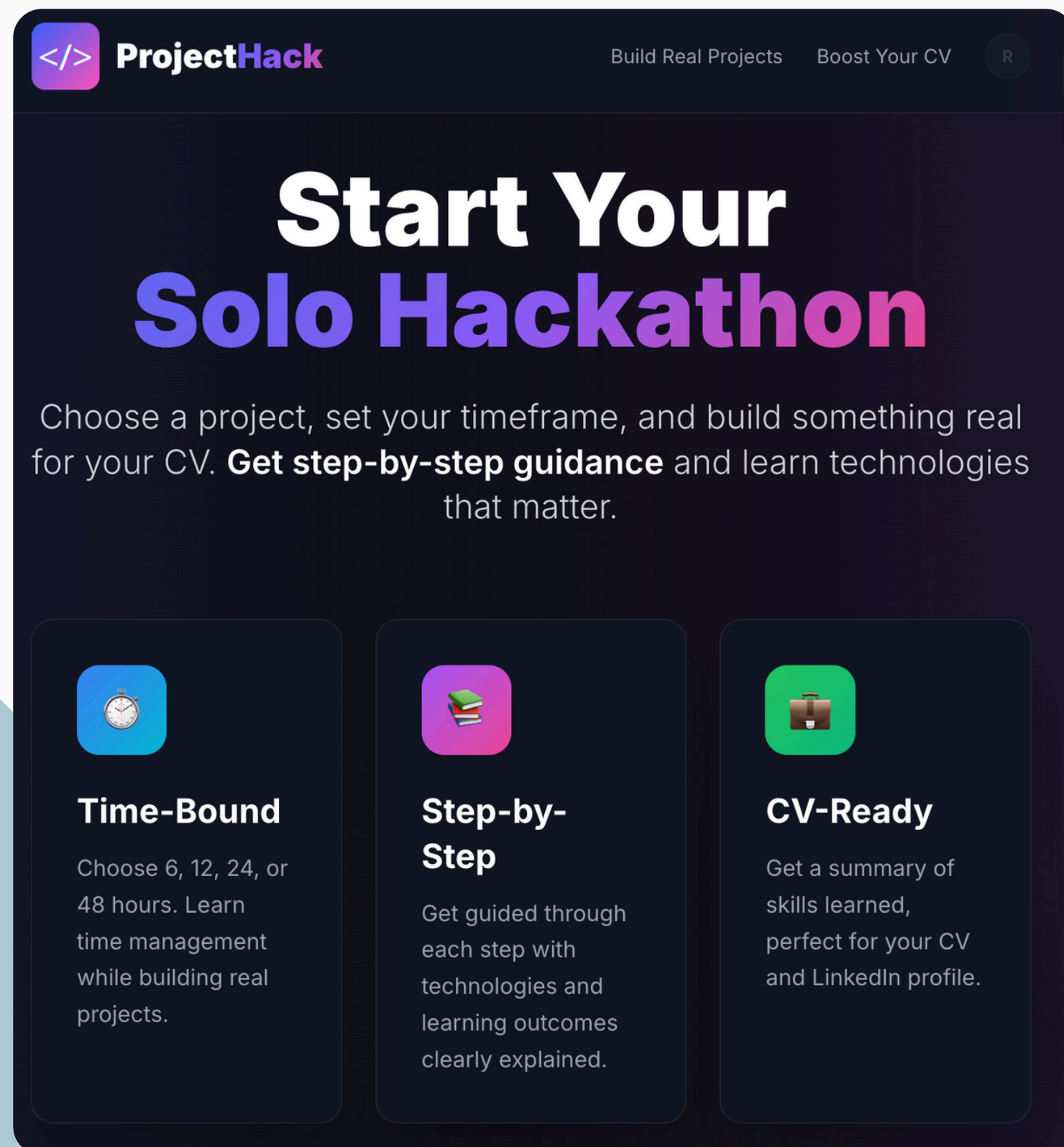
Step 3

Follow a **step-by-step plan** like a personal hackathon. No ready to paste solutions, but estimated time is given. You can see what you learn along the way.

Step 4

You finished the project. Conclude with a **CV-ready summary** of your accomplishments. Review what you've just accomplished and increase your understanding of topics learnt. Don't hesitate to **share it on your LinkedIn** profile.

Step 1



Step 1

ProjectHack

Build Real ProjectsBoost Your CV

Step 2 of 32/3

What technologies interest you?

Select all that apply. We'll recommend projects based on your interests.

Frontend

HTML

CSS

JavaScript

React

Vue.js

Angular

TypeScript

Tailwind CSS

SASS

Backend

Python

Django

Flask

ProjectHack

Build Real ProjectsBoost Your CV

Almost done!

Just a couple more questions to personalize your experience.

Preferred Time Commitment

6 Hours

12 Hours

24 Hours

48 Hours

What types of projects interest you?

Type keywords separated by commas (e.g., "E-commerce, API, Dashboard")

Social Media, Automation

This helps us recommend projects you'll actually enjoy building!

Quick suggestions (click to add):

+ E-commerce

+ Social Media

+ Blog

+ Dashboard

+ API

+ Mobile App

+ Data Visualization

+ Automation

+ Game

 @ndsz

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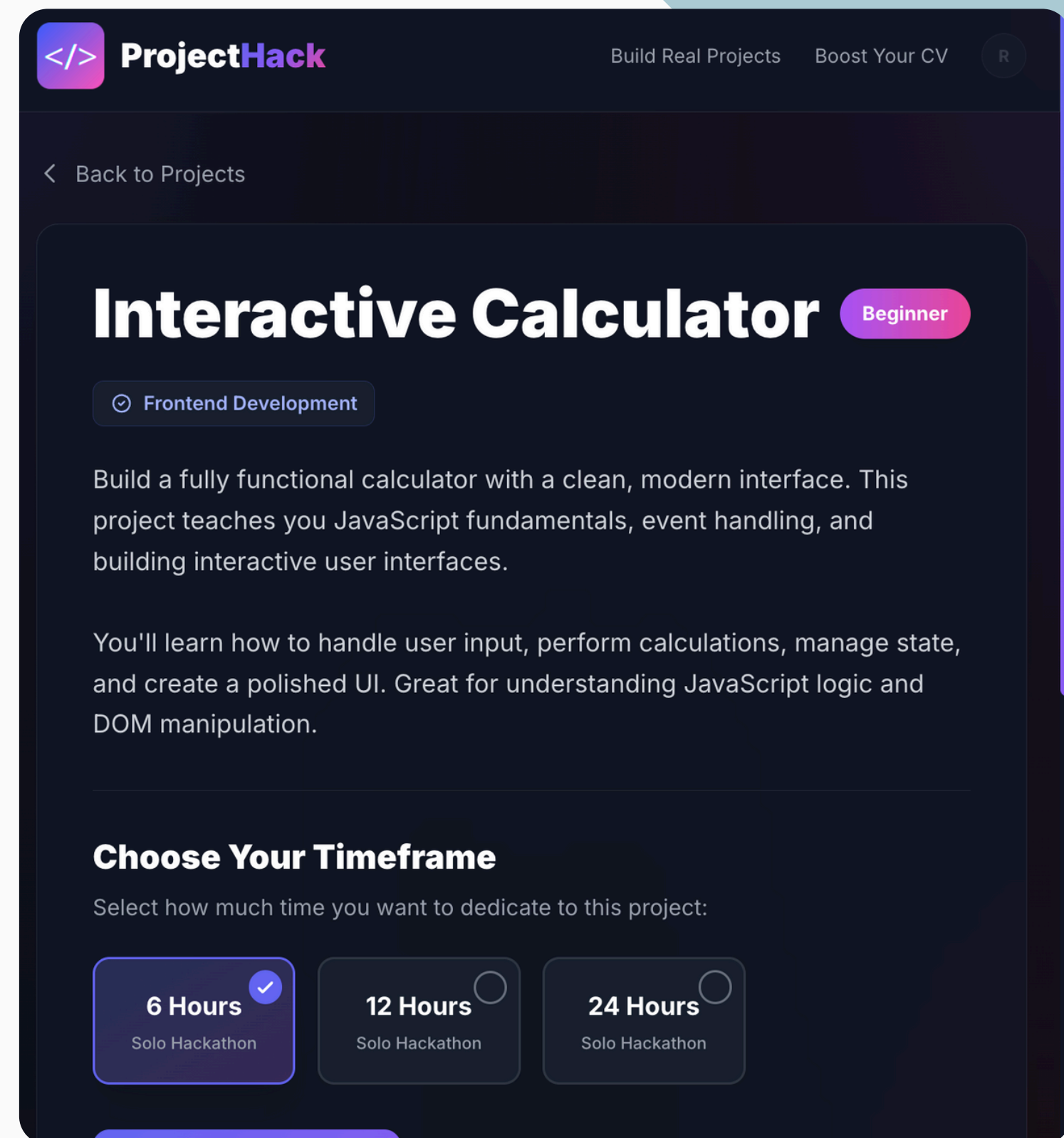
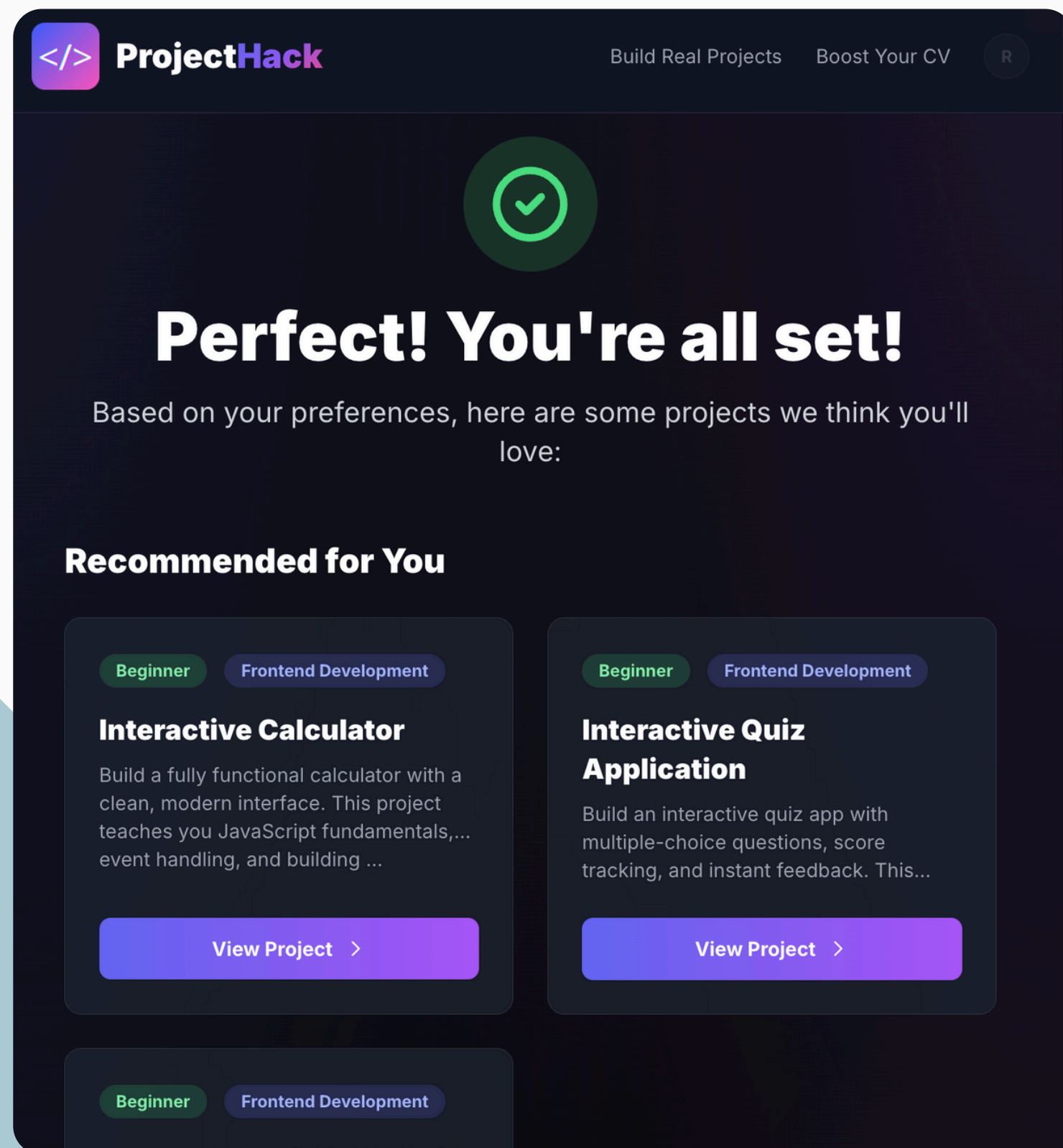
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Step 3

</>

ProjectHack

Build Real Projects

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R

Interactive Calculator

Time Remaining

05:59:39

Step 1 of 6

0% Complete

Setup and HTML Structure

~30 min

Create the HTML structure for your calculator: display screen, number buttons (0-9), operation buttons (+, -, *, /), equals, and clear button.

💡 Technologies in This Step

HTML

Semantic HTML

📌 What You'll Learn

HTML structure for interactive components

✓ Mark Step as Complete

View Summary

</>

ProjectHack

Build Real Projects

Boost Your CV

R

All Steps

✓ Setup and HTML Structure

30 min

✓ Style the Calculator

90 min

✓ Implement Button Click Handlers

45 min

4 Implement Number Input

60 min

5 Implement Basic Operations

90 min

6 Add Clear and Polish

45 min

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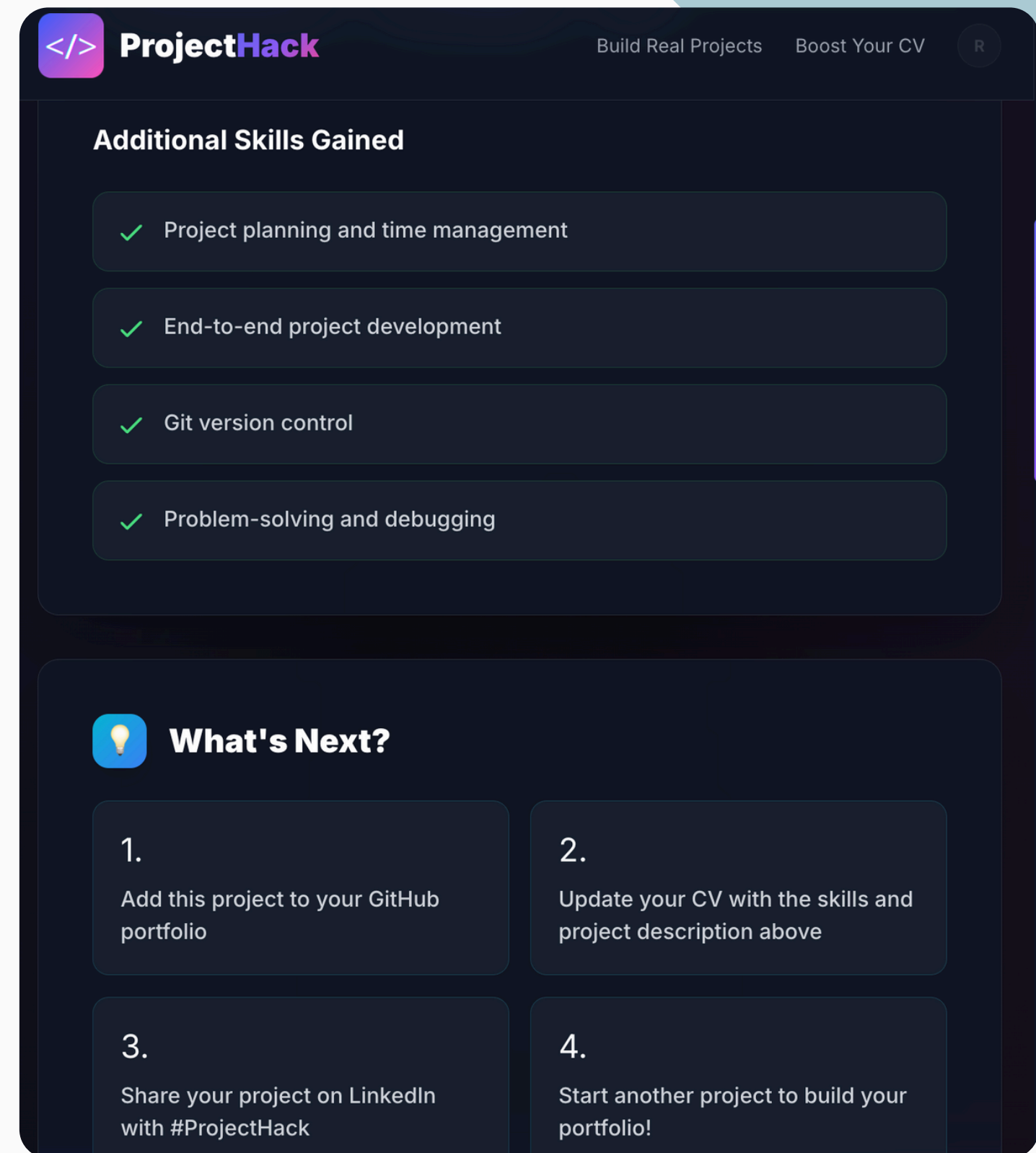
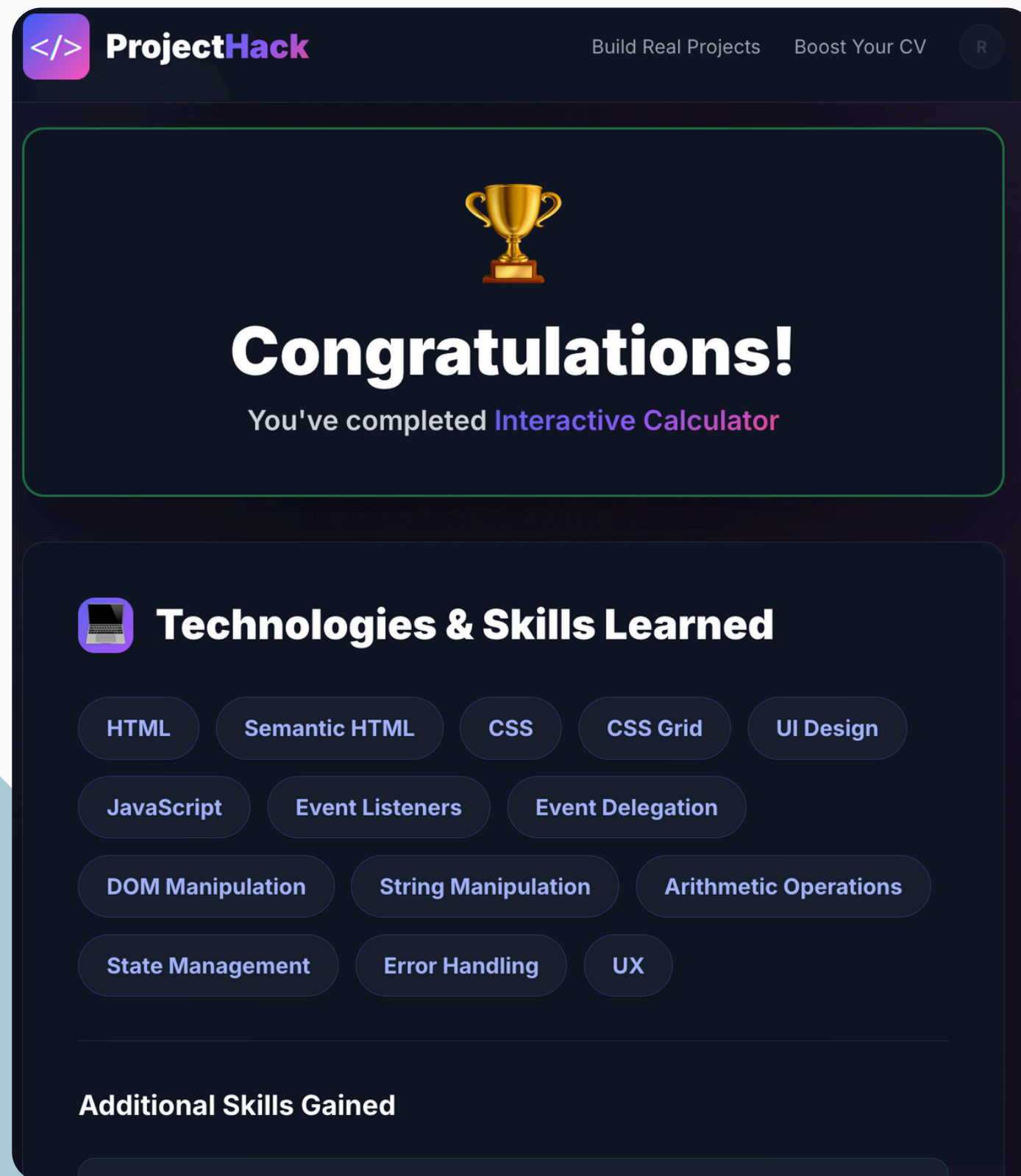
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Step 4



Step 4

 **ProjectHack** Build Real Projects Boost Your CV R

 **CV-Ready Summary**

Project Description:

Built a interactive calculator as part of a 6-hour solo hackathon project.

Key Achievements:

- Completed 6 structured development steps
- Implemented project from concept to working MVP in 6 hours
- Applied version control best practices with Git and GitHub
- Followed step-by-step development methodology

CV Bullet Points:

- Developed interactive calculator using HTML, Semantic HTML, CSS and additional technologies
- Completed project in 6-hour timeframe, demonstrating time management and project planning skills
- Implemented project following structured development methodology with 6 distinct steps
- Utilized Git and GitHub for version control and project documentation

 **Copy Summary to Clipboard**

 **ProjectHack** Build Real Projects Boost Your CV R

 **Share on LinkedIn**

Ready-to-paste LinkedIn post about your project:

🚀 Just completed "Interactive Calculator" with ProjectHack!

🕒 Completed in 6 hours

💻 Skills learned: HTML, Semantic HTML, CSS and more

Built using ProjectHack - a platform that helps you build real projects step-by-step!

🌐 Try ProjectHack: <https://projecthack.onrender.com/>

#ProjectHack #Tech #Development #Progress #Coding #WebDevelopment #Frontend

 **Copy to Clipboard**

 **Share to LinkedIn**



Where Could This Go Next?

ProjectHack at this stage is just a first working prototype, there's so much potential to grow:

- Personalized, AI-generated project ideas for each user
- Real-time hints and the guidance while building
- One-click sharing of your finished project to your favorite platforms
- User accounts with project history, progress tracking, and community support

This is just the beginning. It's not a finished product yet, but sharing and getting feedback at this early stage matters most.

I'm excited to keep building and improving ProjectHack in the future, learning as I go, and seeing what's possible when you start small but share anyway!



Summary

Every project in this series starts as an idea aka problem in my head.

First, I handle the **planning, design, and choice of technologies** myself before starting building the first version. For me, turning an idea into a real product always begins with **thoughtful preparation and intentional decisions.**

This is just the first experiment. I'll be sharing one prototype every 2 weeks, some will remain as experiments, while others may evolve further in the future. **Goal is to share ~20 prototypes in 2026.**

To accelerate my progress and improve my workflow, I support my ideas and design process with AI tools like CursorAI and ChatGPT. I strongly believe this is how these technologies are meant to be used: **not to replace learning and doing everything for us, but to help us learn more, move faster, and deliver better results.**

Let's see what happens when we combine real intent, thoughtful design, and the leverage of powerful tools.



Let's talk

If you're interested in more presentations like this one, practical experiments, honest lessons, and the useful value of AI in hands-on product work, follow me [here](https://projecthack.onrender.com/) for more projects and reflections every 2 weeks!

Check out the prototype here:
<https://projecthack.onrender.com/>

Questions for You:

- What's the biggest barrier you've faced building your first project?
- Would ProjectHack help you or someone you know get started?
- What feature or improvement would you advise?
- How can AI support your learning, not just do the work for you?

 [@ndsz](#)

